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COMMERCIAL & FAMILY SOLICITORS · LEEDS AND HARROGATE

Clear legal advice, and the *fee in writing* before we begin.

Thirty-one lawyers advising owner-managed businesses and families across Yorkshire. Most of our work is fixed-fee, and you will always know who is handling your matter and what happens next.

● First 30-minute call free · Replies within one working day

Halden & Rowe

Ref. HR/CORP/2611
11 November 2026

FIXED-FEE ENGAGEMENT

Shareholders' agreement for a three-founder company

Lead lawyer	Eleanor Halden, Partner
Scope	Draft, two rounds of edits, signing call
Turnaround	First draft in 7 working days
Hourly top-ups	None without your written OK
Fixed fee (ex. VAT)	£2,450

E. Halden
Partner, Corporate

FIXED FEE · AGREED IN WRITING · H&R

38 years advising Yorkshire businesses

84% of matters handled on a fixed fee

<1 working day to reply to new enquiries

4.9 / 5 from 612 verified client reviews

PRACTICE AREAS

Five teams, one standard of service.

Choose an area to see what we handle, how long it usually takes and who will lead your matter.

- Corporate 01
- Employment 02
- Property 03
- Family 04
- Disputes 05

Corporate & commercial

For founders, owner-managers and family companies. We draft the documents that hold a business together and handle the sale or purchase of companies up to around £40m.

WHAT WE HANDLE

- ✓ Shareholders' agreements and articles
- ✓ Buying or selling a business
- ✓ Investment rounds and EMI option schemes
- ✓ Supplier, distribution and SaaS contracts
- ✓ Partner exits and management buy-outs

Lead partner	Eleanor Halden
Typical timeline	1–12 weeks
Fixed fees from	£650
Matters in 2025	214

Book a corporate consultation →

HOW WE WORK

No ticking clock. A price, a plan and a named lawyer.

We quote a fixed fee for most work. Where a matter genuinely can't be fixed, such as a contested trial, we give a stage-by-stage estimate and a cap you can hold us to.

01
Free 30-minute call
Tell us what's happening. We'll say whether we can help and roughly what it will involve.

02
Written fee letter
Within two working days: the scope, the fee, the timeline and the lawyer who will do the work.

03
Regular updates
A short update every Friday while your matter is live, and a direct line to your lawyer.

04
No surprise invoices
If the scope changes, we tell you first and agree any extra cost before we do the work.

Sample fixed fees

SERVICE	WHAT'S INCLUDED	TYPICAL TIME	FIXED FEE
Shareholders' agreement	Up to 4 shareholders, first draft, two rounds of amendments, signing call	2–3 weeks	£2,450 ex. VAT
Employment contract pack	Contract template, staff handbook and three core policies, tailored to your business	10 days	£1,250 ex. VAT
Settlement agreement review	Advice meeting, negotiation of terms, signing the adviser's certificate	3–5 days	£450 often paid by employer
New commercial lease (tenant)	Review of heads of terms and lease, report on title, completion	4–6 weeks	£1,850 ex. VAT & disbursements
Uncontested divorce	Online application, all court steps to final order. Court fee charged at cost	6–8 months	£950 ex. VAT
Prenuptial agreement	Initial meeting, draft agreement, negotiation with the other side's solicitor	4–8 weeks	£2,200 ex. VAT
Debt recovery letter	Letter before action under the pre-action protocol, one follow-up	2 days	£180 ex. VAT

Payment in stages
Larger fees are split across agreed milestones. Nothing is due upfront for fees under £1,000.

Disbursements at cost
Court fees, Land Registry fees and searches are passed on at exactly what we pay.

Price promise
If we go over a fixed fee because of our own delay, the difference is on us.

PARTNERS

The people who will actually do your work.

Every matter has a named partner who reviews it. You will have their direct line from day one.

EH
LEEDS
Eleanor Halden
Managing Partner · Corporate
Qualified in 2003. Has advised on more than 180 business sales, most of them for founders selling the company they started.
M&A · Investment · Shareholders

MR
LEEDS
Marcus Rowe
Partner · Employment
Former in-house counsel at a 2,000-person manufacturer. Known for getting settlements agreed without a hearing.
Tribunal · Exits · HR retainer

PA
HARROGATE
Priya Anand
Partner · Commercial Property
Acts for regional landlords and growing occupiers. Completed 96 leases last year with an average of 31 days from instruction.
Leases · Freehold · Development

CO
HARROGATE
Catherine Osei
Partner · Family
Accredited family mediator and collaborative lawyer. Specialises in separations where one or both people own a business.
Finances · Children · Mediation

DW
LEEDS
Daniel Whitcombe
Partner · Disputes
Solicitor-advocate with rights of audience in the higher courts. Tells clients early if a claim isn't worth pursuing.
Contract · Shareholder · Recovery

JL
LEEDS
Joanna Lister
Senior Associate · Corporate
Runs our start-up desk: incorporations, EMI schemes and seed rounds on fixed, published fees.
Start-ups · EMI · Contracts

OUTCOMES

Results we can put numbers to.

Figures from our 2025 matter records. Every case is different, but you are entitled to know our track record.

1,457 matters closed in 2025

92% of fixed-fee matters finished on the quoted fee

78% of disputes settled before a final hearing

£6.2m recovered for clients in unpaid debts

CORPORATE · SALE
Family-owned joinery sold to a regional group
Three siblings selling a 60-year-old business. We negotiated a pension carve-out and kept the deal on its original timetable.
£11.4m completed in 14 weeks

DISPUTES · RECOVERY
Unpaid invoices from a collapsed main contractor
A steel fabricator was owed for nine months' work. We secured a charge over the contractor's property before administration.
£486k recovered, 96% of the debt

FAMILY · FINANCES
Separation with a jointly owned dental practice
Agreed through two mediation sessions, with a staged buy-out so the practice could keep trading without new borrowing.
0 court hearings needed

Case summaries are anonymised and shared with the clients' permission. Past results do not guarantee a similar outcome.

CLIENT REVIEWS

What clients say once it's over.

We ask every client for feedback when we close their file, and publish all of it, good and bad.

> “
> Eleanor told us on the first call what the sale would cost and roughly when it would complete. Both turned out to be right. After thirty years running the business, that certainty mattered more than anything.
>
> **Graham T.** · Sold a manufacturing business, Wakefield

> I was dreading the divorce. Catherine was calm, explained every option and never let it turn into a fight.
>
> **Rachel M.** · Family client, Harrogate

> Our HR retainer pays for itself. One phone call saved us from a redundancy process that would have gone badly wrong.
>
> **Sunil P.** · Operations director, 45 staff

4.9 average from 612 reviews 97% would recommend us to a friend 11 days average time to fee letter sign-off

FAQ

Questions people ask before they call.

Can't see yours? Call 0113 496 0218 and you'll speak to a person, not a menu.

Is the first consultation really free? −

Yes. The first 30 minutes, by phone or video, costs nothing and commits you to nothing. If you'd like a longer in-person meeting with a partner, that is £150 plus VAT and is deducted from your fee if you instruct us.

What happens if my matter turns out to be more complicated? +

Do you offer legal aid? +

How quickly can you start? +

Can you act if I'm outside Yorkshire? +

How do you check for conflicts of interest? +

BOOK A CONSULTATION

Tell us briefly what's happening.

A lawyer from the right team will call at the time you choose. Everything you share is confidential, even if you don't instruct us.

1 **We check for conflicts**
Same day, using the names you give us.

2 **A lawyer calls you**
At your preferred time, for up to 30 minutes.

3 **You get a written quote**
Within two working days, if you'd like to proceed.

Full name

Phone

Email

Practice area
Choose an area

Preferred day
mm/dd/yyyy

Call by
● Phone ○ Video
○ In person

Preferred time
9–10am Morning | 11–12pm Late morning | 2–3pm Afternoon | 5:30–6:30pm After work

Other party's name (for our conflict check, optional)

What do you need help with?

0/600 · A few sentences is plenty. Please don't send documents yet.

☐ I understand this enquiry doesn't make me a client until I sign a fee letter, and I agree to be contacted about it.

We reply within one working day. Your details are never shared outside the firm.

OFFICES

Two offices, both a short walk from the station.

Step-free access and private meeting rooms in both. Free visitor parking at Harrogate; Leeds is a five-minute walk from the station.

● Closed now · opens tomorrow at 8:30am

Leeds

4th floor, 12 Calder Row
Leeds LS1 4QX

Mon–Fri	8:30am – 5:30pm
Phone	0113 496 0218
Email	leeds@haldenrowe.example

● Closed now · opens tomorrow at 9:00am

Harrogate

2 Parliament Terrace
Harrogate HG1 2RE

Mon–Fri	9:00am – 5:00pm
Phone	01423 496 077
Email	harrogate@haldenrowe.example

H&R Halden & Rowe
SOLICITORS · EST. 1987

Commercial and family law for Yorkshire businesses and the people behind them. Fixed fees, agreed in writing.

PRACTICE AREAS
- Corporate
- Employment
- Property
- Family
- Disputes

THE FIRM
- Fees & how we work
- Our people
- Results
- FAQ
- Book a consultation

CONTACT
- Leeds 0113 496 0218
- Harrogate 01423 496 077
- hello@haldenrowe.example

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